
How to sleep on *any flight*.

The habits frequent flyers actually use to land rested, gathered into one short guide. No gadgets you don't already have, no willpower required.

Three things are working *against you*.

Cabin light keeps your brain in daytime mode. The engine sits at a steady roar that your nervous system reads as alert. And dry, pressurised air leaves you restless without knowing why. Fix those three and the rest is easy. Here is how, in order.

BEFORE YOU BOARD

1 **Pick your seat on purpose**

Choose a window, a row ahead of the wing, and a spot away from galleys and toilets. The window gives you a wall to lean on and control over the blind. The middle of the cabin is the quietest and the smoothest.

2 **Nudge your body clock early**

For the two or three nights before a long flight, move your bedtime an hour toward your destination's time zone. You land with less of a gap to close, so the first night abroad does not wreck you.

3 **Pack a small sleep kit**

A mask that blocks all light, something to steady the sound, a thin layer for when the cabin turns cold, and a bottle of water you fill after security. Keep it in the seat pocket, not the overhead bin, so you are not up and rummaging later.

4 **Eat before, not during**

Have a proper meal in the terminal and you can skip the cart service when it rolls past at the worst possible moment. A full digestion keeps you awake; a light stomach lets you drift.

5 Kill the light completely

Not dimmed, gone. Even a sliver of light through a cheap mask tells your brain to stay up. Full darkness is the single biggest lever you have on a plane, and it works within minutes.

6 Cover the engine with steady sound

You are not trying to hear silence, you are trying to bury the sudden noises that jolt you awake. A constant, soft sound, brown noise, rain, or a slow playlist, smooths the cabin into one flat hum your brain stops tracking.

7 Recline early and hold your head

Recline as soon as you are allowed, before the person behind you sets up a laptop. Then support your neck so your head cannot fall forward, which is what wakes most people every few minutes.

8 Skip the free drinks

Alcohol feels like it helps and then fragments the back half of your sleep. Caffeine lingers for hours. Water is the one thing the dry cabin is quietly asking for, so drink more of it than feels necessary.

9 Run your home wind-down

Your body falls asleep on cues, not on command. Use the same ones you use at home: the same playlist, the same order of small things. On a plane those cues matter more, not less.

10 Let rest be enough

If deep sleep does not come, lying still with your eyes covered and the noise gone still restores you. Stop checking whether you are asleep. That checking is usually the only thing keeping you awake.

Two of those steps, *in one move*.

Steps five and six, killing the light and covering the engine, are the two that do the heavy lifting, and the two that are hardest to do with separate gear sliding around your face and ears.

YOUR KALMELY

One mask. *Full dark, steady sound.*

The Kalmely Sleep Mask blocks 100% of the light and holds flat speakers right over your ears, so you set the darkness and the sound in a single gesture and then forget both are there. No earbuds digging in, no mask riding up.

Everything else in this guide is yours to use on any flight, with or without us. We just wanted the first two steps to be the easy ones.

Safe travels, and a real night's rest when you land.

— The Kalmely team